

1955, January 30.

The following is a faithful transcription of a typewritten letter by the
Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

ST. FELIX PRIARY. January 30th 1955. Blessed be God in all His designs!
Huntington, Indiana

Ven. Sister Mary Bernice, O. P. St. Andrew's Convent, Grand Rapids, Mich.

God bless you Sister Mary Bernice. God bless you and yours these days -
at once - days of threatening forebodeings and God's outstanding mercies.
God bless our poor, modern Humanity, with all its wonderful gifts; but too,
alas! with its innumerable weaknesses and its appalling absurdities;
atheism, the chief and unholy parent of themall.

Dear Sister M. Bernice: I read your letter over again this Morning and
surely do sympathize with you and with the many, these days whose circum-
stances and conditions seem to callforth lamentations quite similar to your-
own. I'd like to answer them each one in detail if that were possible, I
think I've started to answer yours - this of Jan. 16th at least a half dozen
times. I am glad to hear from you, even though the tone of your letter is
anything but too bright. It only convinces me more and more that there is
something I am inclined to call drastic, shortly ahead of us. One thing is
certain, if these are the days of antichrist as it seems to be more and more
tending to a general conviction that way; then we must be on our guard
against being scandalized; for it seems to me that it is most especially to
activities of antichrist and his agents that Jesus refers in His admonition:
"Beware of Scandals: for it is necessary that scandals come. Nevertheless,
woe to that man by whom the scandal cometh." St. Bernard the outstanding
Doctor of the Church of the eleventh century was wont to exhort the people
of his day, especially against taking scandal: "Since the Crucifixion of
Jusus Christ, "he would admonish, "it is never reasonable to take scandal."
.....Ah! Because from that climax of scandal God saved Humanity - decre-
ed Heaven's rehabilitation. Glory be to God! ... Ascetic writers always
stress openness and confidence with our superiors as with those represent-
ing or taking God's place in our regards.

As for "religious" in a community who persist in refusing to speak to
member of the community because of some petty offense or dislike ? ! The
very fact of such example would in my opinion indicate as a rule, PITIFUL
narrowness. Patience in such cases and prayer for conversion of sinners -
always including one'self - charity beginning at home. In this way we
can help Jesus in His great purpose of converting and redeeming Humanity.